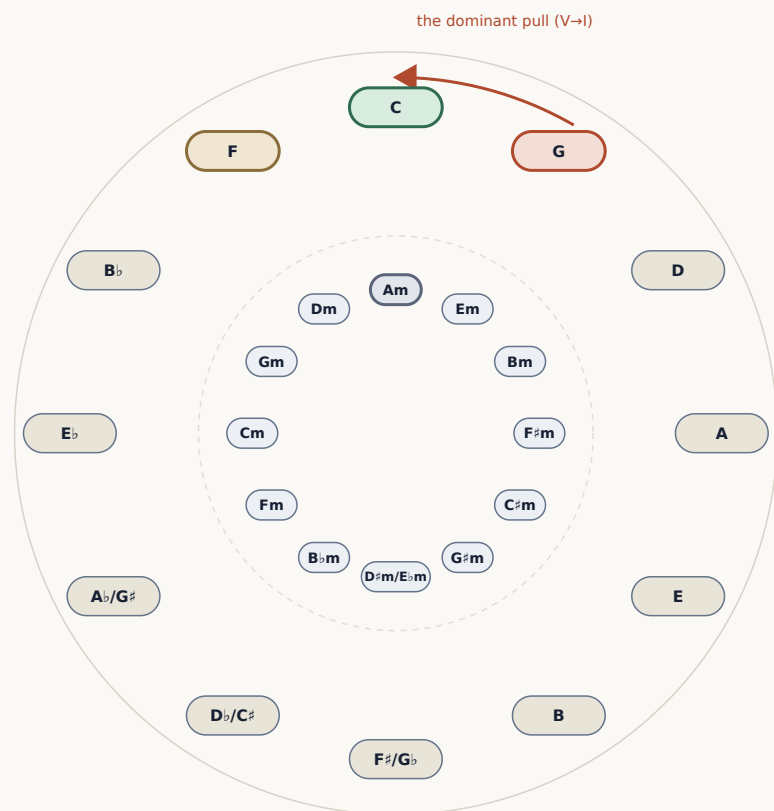


Chord progressions in C major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Diatonic chords in C major

I · C tonic	ii · Dm subdom.	iii · Em linking	IV · F subdom.	V · G dominant	vi · Am rel. minor	vii° · Bdim side
x ○ ○	x x ○	○ ○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○	x ○ ○	
C I · tonic	Dm ii · subdom.	Em iii · linking	F IV · subdom.	G V · dominant	Am vi · rel. minor	

Bdim
vii° · skip it
pull substitute:
B7
x21202

Notation: ○ = open string, x = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in C major)

I - IV - V

C - F - G

the staple of rock and folk

I - V - vi - IV

C - G - Am - F

the pop "four-chord"

vi - IV - I - V

Am - F - C - G

the same four chords, but home in the minor

I - vi - IV - V

C - Am - F - G

do-wop, the 1950s

ii - V - I

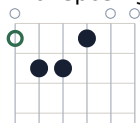
Dm - G - C

a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

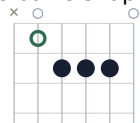
C7	C7	C7	C7	F7	F7	C7	C7	G7	F7	C7	G7
----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----

Transposing on the guitar: one barre shape, any key



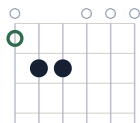
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



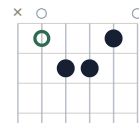
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

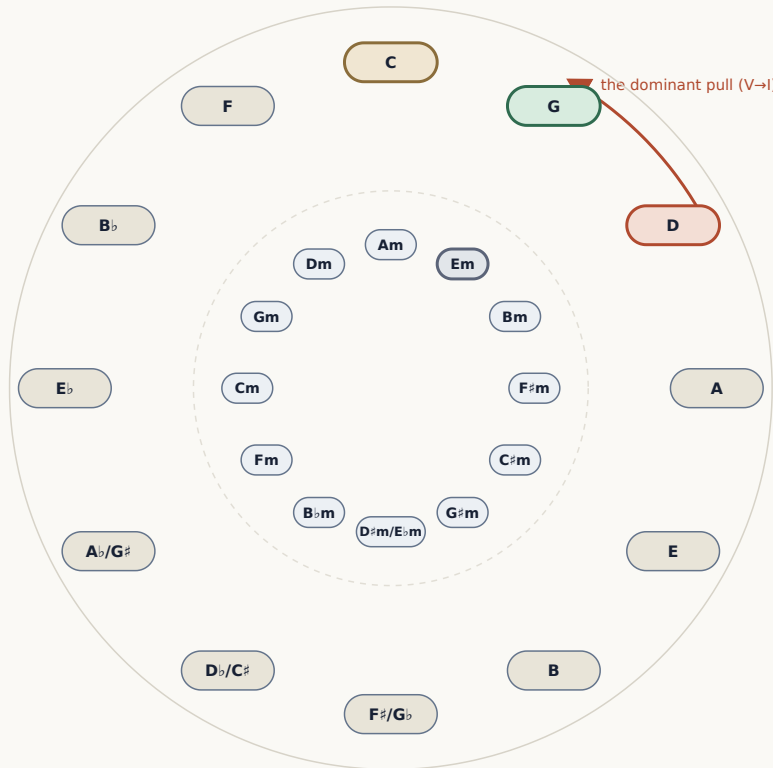
Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

How to read it: a barre = one finger across all strings,
at the chosen fret — the shape stays, only the position changes.
The green ring marks where the tonic sits (the chord's name).
Progressions work in ANY key — you shift them along the circle of fifths:
e.g. C-G-Am-F → G major: G-D-Em-C (a 7-fret shift).

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**
The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in G major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Diatonic chords in G major

I · G tonic	ii · Am subdom.	iii · Bm linking	IV · C subdom.	V · D dominant	vi · Em rel. minor	vii° · F#dim side
○ ○ ○	× ○ ○	○ ×	× ○ ○	× × ○	○ ○ ○	
G I · tonic	Am ii · subdom.	Bm iii · linking	C IV · subdom.	D V · dominant	Em vi · rel. minor	

F#dim
vii° · skip it
pull substitute:
F#7
242322

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in G major)

I - IV - V	G - C - D	the staple of rock and folk
I - V - vi - IV	G - D - Em - C	the pop "four-chord"
vi - IV - I - V	Em - C - G - D	the same four chords, but home in the minor
I - vi - IV - V	G - Em - C - D	do-wop, the 1950s
ii - V - I	Am - D - G	a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

G7	G7	G7	G7	C7	C7	G7	G7	D7	C7	G7	D7
----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----

Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits

E major shape
F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6

A major shape
B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5

Em minor shape
F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6

Am minor shape
Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of G:

capo 2 + F major shapes

G, Am, Bm, C, D, Em — all easy.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

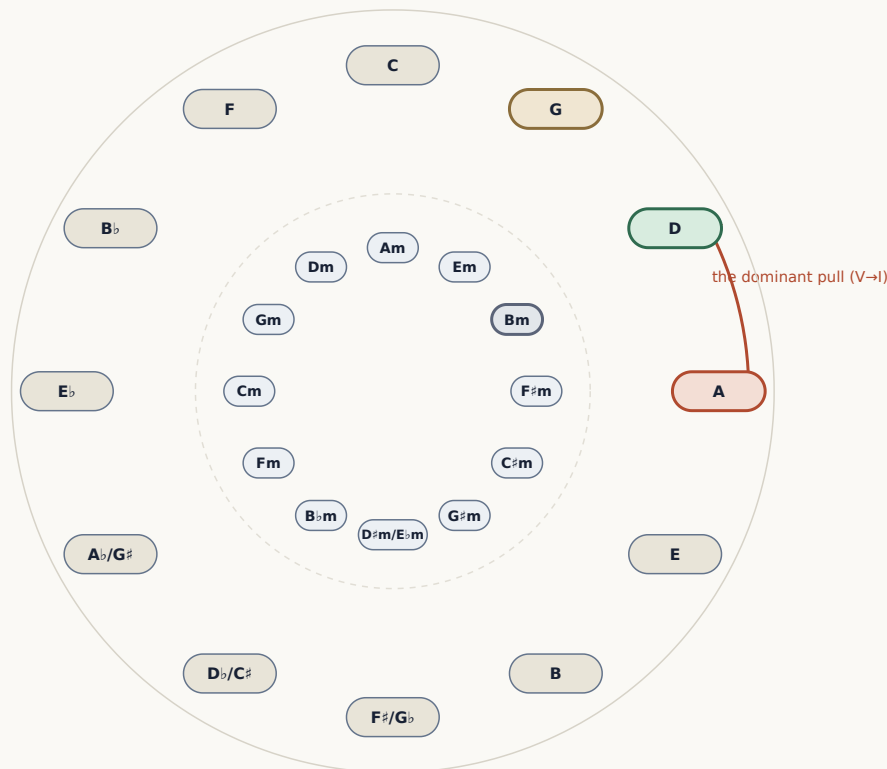
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in D major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Diatonic chords in D major

I · D tonic	ii · Em subdom.	iii · F#m linking	IV · G subdom.	V · A dominant	vi · Bm rel. minor	vii° · C#dim side
x x o	o o o o	2 x x x x x	o o o	x o o x	2 x x x x x	
D I · tonic	Em ii · subdom.	F#m iii · linking	G IV · subdom.	A V · dominant	Bm vi · rel. minor	

C#dim
vii° · skip it
pull substitute:
C#7
x46464

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in D major)

I - IV - V	D - G - A	the staple of rock and folk
I - V - vi - IV	D - A - Bm - G	the pop "four-chord"
vi - IV - I - V	Bm - G - D - A	the same four chords, but home in the minor
I - vi - IV - V	D - Bm - G - A	do-wop, the 1950s
ii - V - I	Em - A - D	a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

D7	D7	D7	D7	G7	G7	D7	D7	A7	G7	D7	A7
----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----

Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits

E major shape
F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6

A major shape
B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5

Em minor shape
F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6

Am minor shape
Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

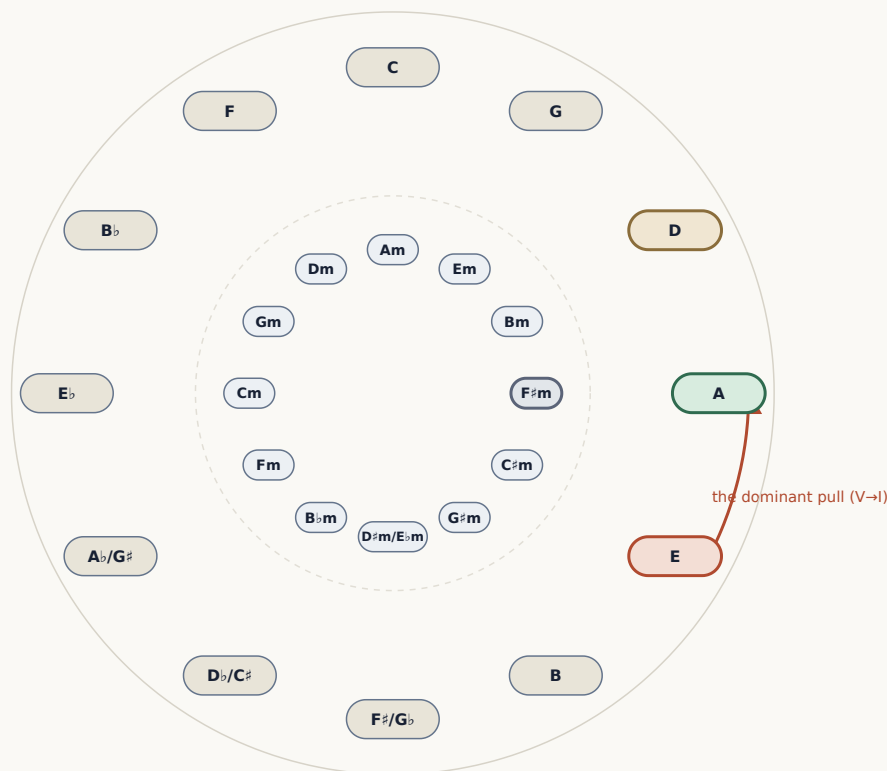
The easiest way — the key of D:

capo 2 + C major shapes
D, Em, F#m, G, A, Bm — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes up by N frets — you land in this page's key.
Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**
The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in A major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Diatonic chords in A major

I · A tonic	ii · Bm subdom.	iii · C#m linking	IV · D subdom.	V · E dominant	vi · F#m rel. minor	vii° · G#dim side
x ○ ○ ○ ○ ○	x ○ ○ ○ ○ ○	x ○ ○ ○ ○ ○	x x ○ ○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
A I · tonic	Bm ii · subdom.	C#m iii · linking	D IV · subdom.	E V · dominant	F#m vi · rel. minor	

G#dim
vii° · skip it
pull substitute:
G#7
464544

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in A major)

I - IV - V

A - D - E

the staple of rock and folk

I - V - vi - IV

A - E - F#m - D

the pop "four-chord"

vi - IV - I - V

F#m - D - A - E

the same four chords, but home in the minor

I - vi - IV - V

A - F#m - D - E

do-wop, the 1950s

ii - V - I

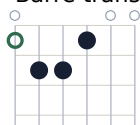
Bm - E - A

a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

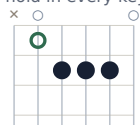
A7	A7	A7	A7	D7	D7	A7	A7	E7	D7	A7	E7
----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----

Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



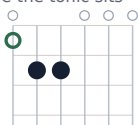
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



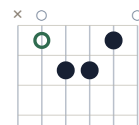
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of A:

capo 2 + G major shapes

A, Bm, C#m, D, E, F#m — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

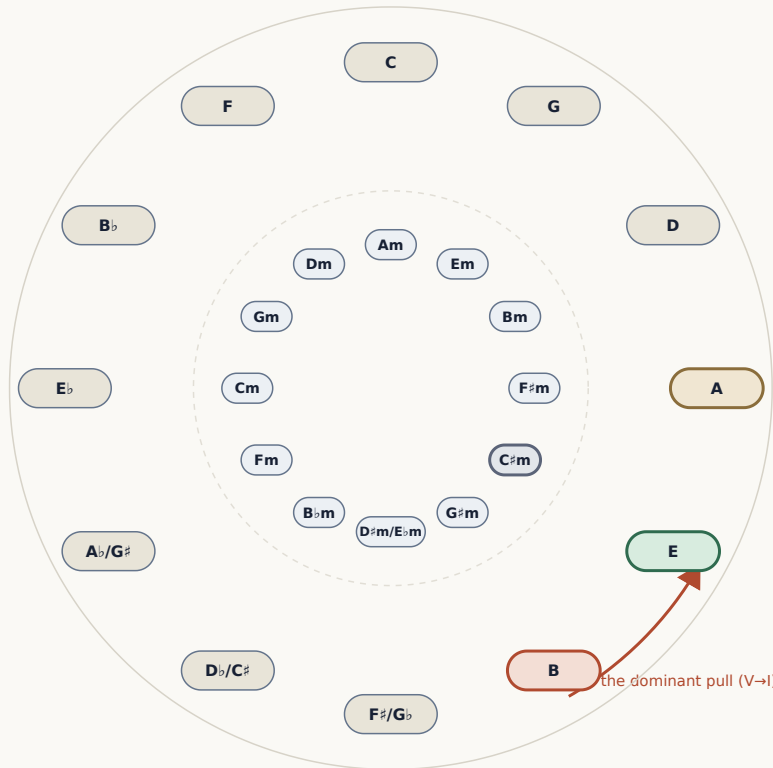
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in E major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Diatonic chords in E major

I · E tonic	ii · F#m subdom.	iii · G#m linking	IV · A subdom.	V · B dominant	vi · C#m rel. minor	vii° · D#dim side
○ ○ ○	2 ○ ○ ○ ○	4 ○ ○ ○ ○ ○	× ○ ○ ○	2 × ○ ○ ○	4 × ○ ○ ○ ○	× ○ ○ ○ ○
E I · tonic	F#m ii · subdom.	G#m iii · linking	A IV · subdom.	B V · dominant	C#m vi · rel. minor	

D#dim
vii° · skip it
pull substitute:
D#7
x68686

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in E major)

I - IV - V	E - A - B	the staple of rock and folk
I - V - vi - IV	E - B - C#m - A	the pop "four-chord"
vi - IV - I - V	C#m - A - E - B	the same four chords, but home in the minor
I - vi - IV - V	E - C#m - A - B	do-wop, the 1950s
ii - V - I	F#m - B - E	a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

E7	E7	E7	E7	A7	A7	E7	E7	B7	A7	E7	B7
----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----

Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits

E major shape F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10 tonic on string 6	A major shape B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8 tonic on string 5	Em minor shape F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10 tonic on string 6	Am minor shape Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8 tonic on string 5
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The easiest way — the key of E:

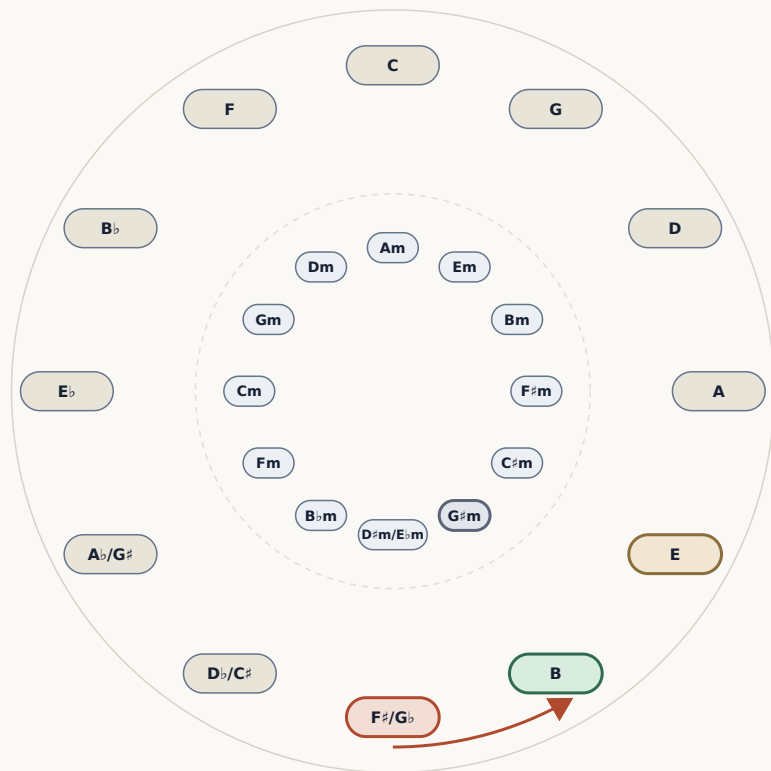
capo 2 + D major shapes
E, F#m, G#m, A, B, C#m — fewer barres.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**
The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in B major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Diatonic chords in B major

I · B tonic	ii · C#m subdom.	iii · D#m linking	IV · E subdom.	V · F# dominant	vi · G#m rel. minor	vii° · A#dim side
x	x	x	o	o	o	o
2	4	6		2	4	
B I · tonic	C#m ii · subdom.	D#m iii · linking	E IV · subdom.	F# V · dominant	G#m vi · rel. minor	

A#dim
vii° · skip it
pull substitute:
A#7
x13131

Notation: o = open string, x = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in B major)

I - IV - V

B - E - F#

the staple of rock and folk

I - V - vi - IV

B - F# - G#m - E

the pop "four-chord"

vi - IV - I - V

G#m - E - B - F#

the same four chords, but home in the minor

I - vi - IV - V

B - G#m - E - F#

do-wop, the 1950s

ii - V - I

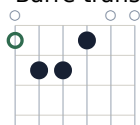
C#m - F# - B

a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

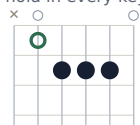
B7	B7	B7	B7	E7	E7	B7	B7	F#7	E7	B7	F#7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



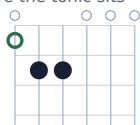
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



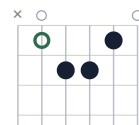
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of B:

capo 2 + A major shapes

B, C#m, D#m, E, F#, G#m — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

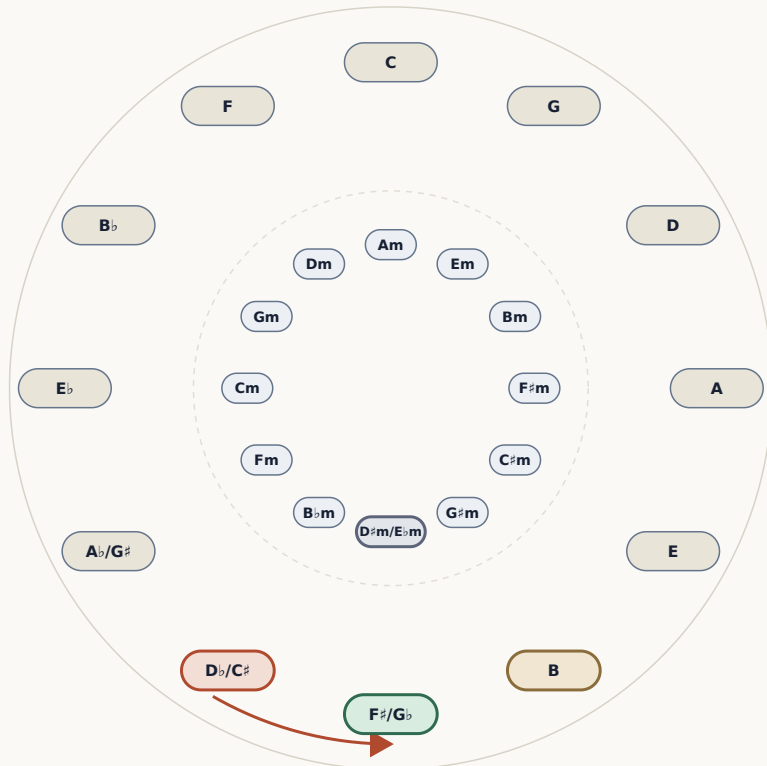
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in F# major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



the dominant pull (V->I)
Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Diatonic chords in F# major

I · F# tonic	ii · G#m subdom.	iii · A#m linking	IV · B subdom.	V · C# dominant	vi · D#m rel. minor	vii° · E#dim side
F# I · tonic	G#m ii · subdom.	A#m iii · linking	B IV · subdom.	C# V · dominant	D#m vi · rel. minor	E#dim vii° · skip it pull substitute: E#7 = F7 131211

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in F# major)

I - IV - V

F# - B - C#

the staple of rock and folk

I - V - vi - IV

F# - C# - D#m - B

the pop "four-chord"

vi - IV - I - V

D#m - B - F# - C#

the same four chords, but home in the minor

I - vi - IV - V

F# - D#m - B - C#

do-wop, the 1950s

ii - V - I

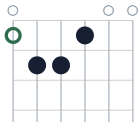
G#m - C# - F#

a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

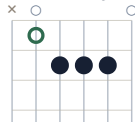
F#7	F#7	F#7	F#7	B7	B7	F#7	F#7	C#7	B7	F#7	C#7
-----	-----	-----	-----	----	----	-----	-----	-----	----	-----	-----

Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



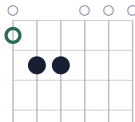
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



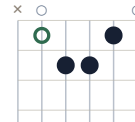
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of F#:

capo 2 + E major shapes

F#, G#m, A#m, B, C#, D#m — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

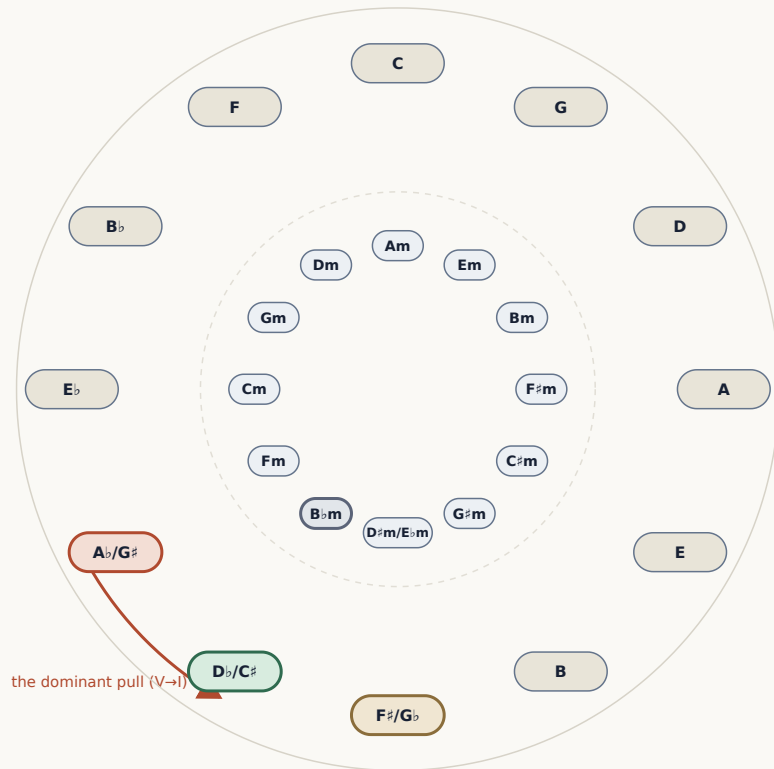
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: I tonic · IV subdominant · V dominant · vi rel. minor

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in D $\flat$ major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Diatonic chords in D $\flat$ major

I · D $\flat$ tonic	ii · E $\flat$ m subdom.	iii · Fm linking	IV · G $\flat$ subdom.	V · A $\flat$ dominant	vi · B $\flat$ m rel. minor	vii $^\circ$ · Cdim side
9 D $\flat$ I · tonic	6 E $\flat$ m ii · subdom.	6 Fm iii · linking	2 G $\flat$ IV · subdom.	4 A $\flat$ V · dominant	4 B $\flat$ m vi · rel. minor	Cdim vii $^\circ$ · skip it pull substitute: C7 x32310

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in D $\flat$ major)

I - IV - V

D $\flat$ - G $\flat$ - A $\flat$

the staple of rock and folk

I - V - vi - IV

D $\flat$ - A $\flat$ - B $\flat$ m - G $\flat$

the pop "four-chord"

vi - IV - I - V

B $\flat$ m - G $\flat$ - D $\flat$ - A $\flat$

the same four chords, but home in the minor

I - vi - IV - V

D $\flat$ - B $\flat$ m - G $\flat$ - A $\flat$

do-wop, the 1950s

ii - V - I

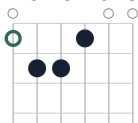
E $\flat$ m - A $\flat$ - D $\flat$

a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

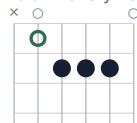
D $\flat$ 7 D $\flat$ 7 D $\flat$ 7 D $\flat$ 7 G $\flat$ 7 G $\flat$ 7 D $\flat$ 7 D $\flat$ 7 A $\flat$ 7 G $\flat$ 7 D $\flat$ 7 A $\flat$ 7

Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



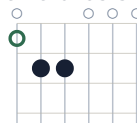
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



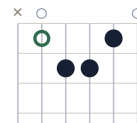
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of D $\flat$:

capo 1 + C major shapes

D $\flat$, E $\flat$ m, Fm, G $\flat$, A $\flat$, B $\flat$ m — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

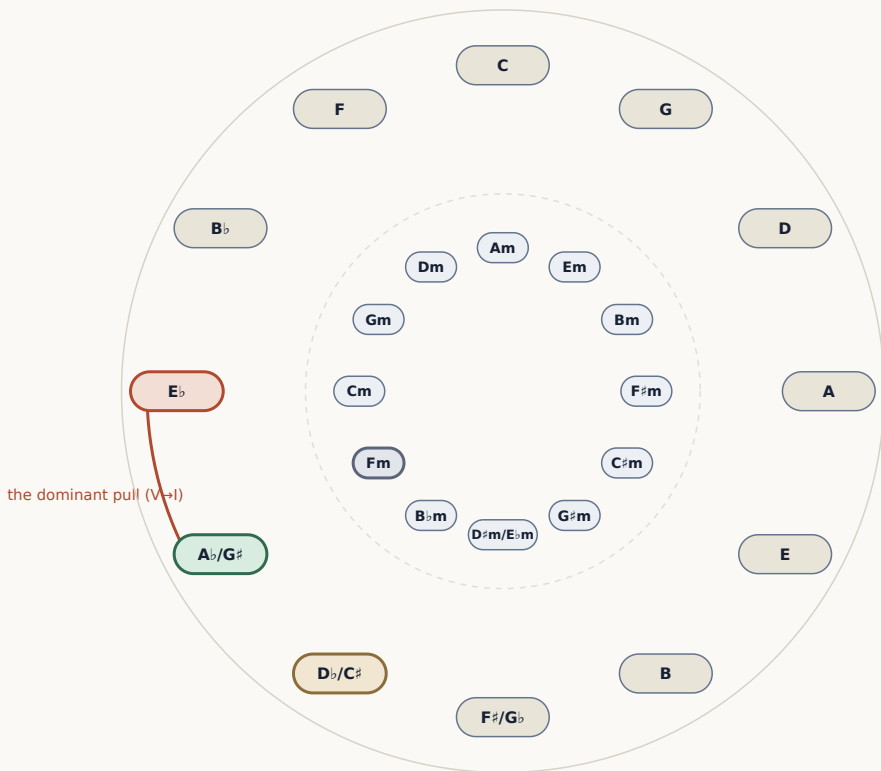
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: I tonic · IV subdominant · V dominant · vi rel. minor

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in A $\flat$ major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Diatonic chords in A $\flat$ major

I · A $\flat$ tonic	ii · B $\flat$ m subdom.	iii · Cm linking	IV · D $\flat$ subdom.	V · E $\flat$ dominant	vi · Fm rel. minor	vii $^\circ$ · Gdim side
4	x	x	9	x	6	
A $\flat$ I · tonic	B $\flat$ m ii · subdom.	Cm iii · linking	D $\flat$ IV · subdom.	E $\flat$ V · dominant	Fm vi · rel. minor	

Gdim
vii $^\circ$ · skip it
pull substitute:
G7
320001

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in A $\flat$ major)

I - IV - V

A $\flat$ - D $\flat$ - E $\flat$

the staple of rock and folk

I - V - vi - IV

A $\flat$ - E $\flat$ - Fm - D $\flat$

the pop "four-chord"

vi - IV - I - V

Fm - D $\flat$ - A $\flat$ - E $\flat$

the same four chords, but home in the minor

I - vi - IV - V

A $\flat$ - Fm - D $\flat$ - E $\flat$

do-wop, the 1950s

ii - V - I

B $\flat$ m - E $\flat$ - A $\flat$

a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

A $\flat$ 7	A $\flat$ 7	A $\flat$ 7	A $\flat$ 7	D $\flat$ 7	D $\flat$ 7	A $\flat$ 7	A $\flat$ 7	E $\flat$ 7	D $\flat$ 7	A $\flat$ 7	E $\flat$ 7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits

E major shape
F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6

A major shape
B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5

Em minor shape
F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6

Am minor shape
Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of A $\flat$:

capo 1 + G major shapes

A $\flat$, B $\flat$ m, Cm, D $\flat$, E $\flat$, Fm — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

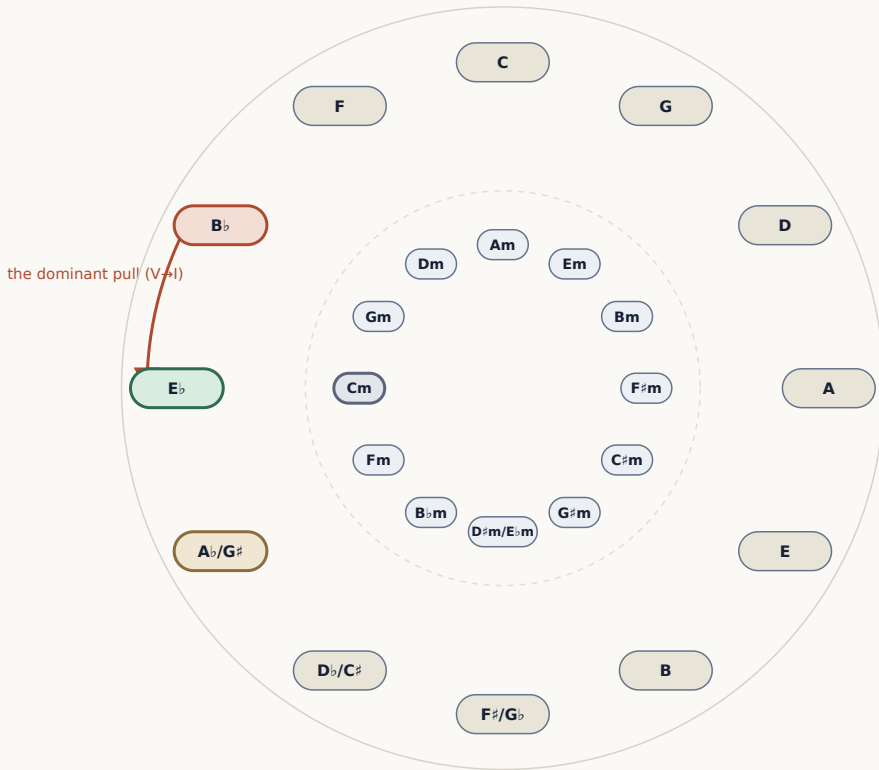
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in E_b major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Diatonic chords in E_b major

I · E _b tonic	ii · Fm subdom.	iii · Gm linking	IV · A _b subdom.	V · B _b dominant	vi · Cm rel. minor	vii° · Ddim side
x	x	3	4	x	x	
6					3	
E _b I · tonic	Fm ii · subdom.	Gm iii · linking	A _b IV · subdom.	B _b V · dominant	Cm vi · rel. minor	Ddim vii° · skip it pull substitute: D7 xx0212

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in E_b major)

I - IV - V

E_b - A_b - B_b

the staple of rock and folk

I - V - vi - IV

E_b - B_b - Cm - A_b

the pop "four-chord"

vi - IV - I - V

Cm - A_b - E_b - B_b

the same four chords, but home in the minor

I - vi - IV - V

E_b - Cm - A_b - B_b

do-wop, the 1950s

ii - V - I

Fm - B_b - E_b

a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

E _b 7	E _b 7	E _b 7	E _b 7	A _b 7	A _b 7	E _b 7	E _b 7	B _b 7	A _b 7	E _b 7	B _b 7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits

E major shape
F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6

A major shape
B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5

Em minor shape
F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6

Am minor shape
Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of E_b:

capo 3 + C major shapes

E_b, Fm, Gm, A_b, B_b, Cm — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

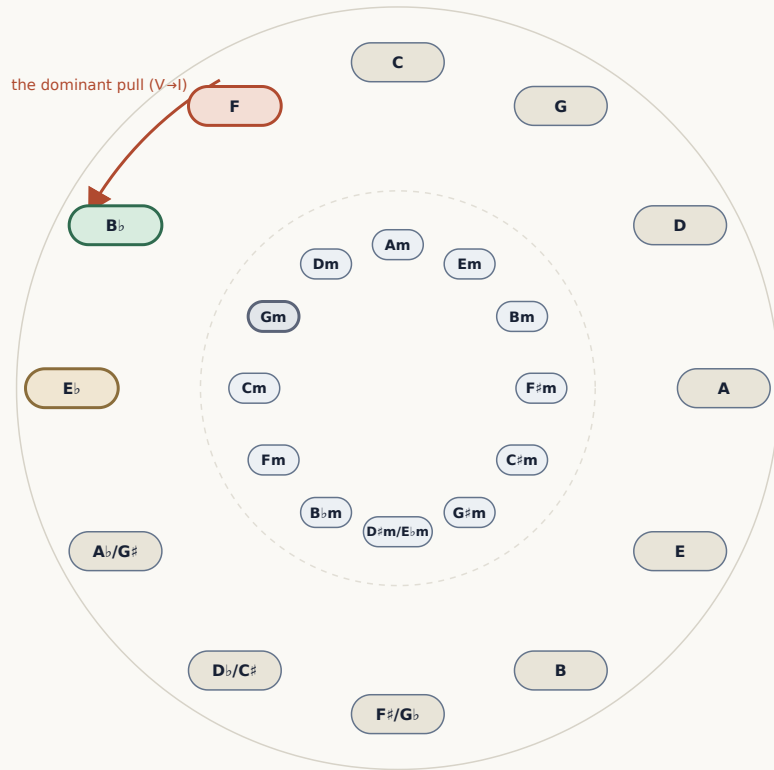
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: **I** tonic · **IV** subdominant · **V** dominant · **vi** rel. minor

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in B $\flat$ major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Diatonic chords in B $\flat$ major

I · B $\flat$ tonic	ii · Cm subdom.	iii · Dm linking	IV · E $\flat$ subdom.	V · F dominant	vi · Gm rel. minor	vii $^{\circ}$ · Adim side
x	x	x x ○	x			
B $\flat$ I · tonic	Cm ii · subdom.	Dm iii · linking	E $\flat$ IV · subdom.	F V · dominant	Gm vi · rel. minor	

Adim
vii $^{\circ}$ · skip it
pull substitute:
A7
x02020

Notation: ○ = open string, x = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in B $\flat$ major)

I - IV - V

B $\flat$ - E $\flat$ - F

the staple of rock and folk

I - V - vi - IV

B $\flat$ - F - Gm - E $\flat$

the pop "four-chord"

vi - IV - I - V

Gm - E $\flat$ - B $\flat$ - F

the same four chords, but home in the minor

I - vi - IV - V

B $\flat$ - Gm - E $\flat$ - F

do-wop, the 1950s

ii - V - I

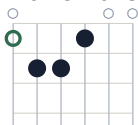
Cm - F - B $\flat$

a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

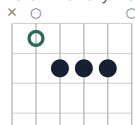
B $\flat$ 7	B $\flat$ 7	B $\flat$ 7	B $\flat$ 7	E $\flat$ 7	E $\flat$ 7	B $\flat$ 7	B $\flat$ 7	F7	E $\flat$ 7	B $\flat$ 7	F7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



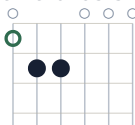
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



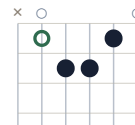
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of B $\flat$:

capo 1 + A major shapes

B $\flat$, Cm, Dm, E $\flat$, F, Gm — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

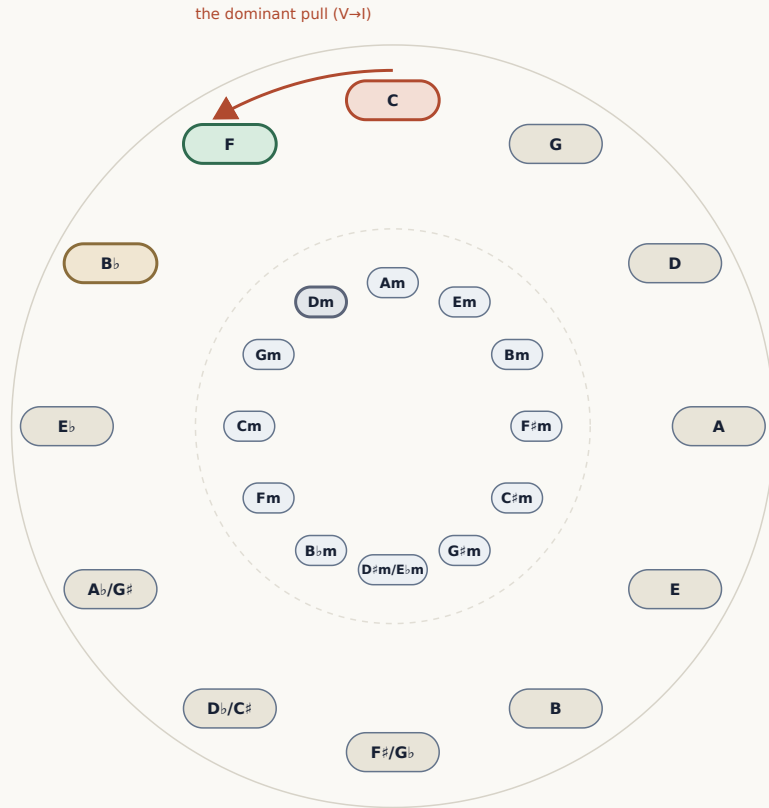
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in F major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Diatonic chords in F major

I · F tonic	ii · Gm subdom.	iii · Am linking	IV · B $\flat$ subdom.	V · C dominant	vi · Dm rel. minor	vii $^\circ$ · Edim side
F I · tonic	Gm ii · subdom.	Am iii · linking	B $\flat$ IV · subdom.	C V · dominant	Dm vi · rel. minor	Edim vii $^\circ$ · skip it pull substitute: E7 020100

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in F major)

I - IV - V

F - B $\flat$ - C

the staple of rock and folk

I - V - vi - IV

F - C - Dm - B $\flat$

the pop "four-chord"

vi - IV - I - V

Dm - B $\flat$ - F - C

the same four chords, but home in the minor

I - vi - IV - V

F - Dm - B $\flat$ - C

do-wop, the 1950s

ii - V - I

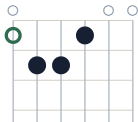
Gm - C - F

a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

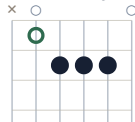
F7	F7	F7	F7	B $\flat$ 7	B $\flat$ 7	F7	F7	C7	B $\flat$ 7	F7	C7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



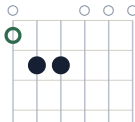
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



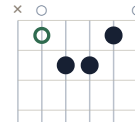
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of F:

F/Gm/B $\flat$ barre, Am/C/D open; otherwise capo 5 + shapes
C major → F, Gm, Am, B $\flat$, C, Dm.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: I tonic · IV subdominant · V dominant · vi rel. minor

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.